Experiment 8
Case Study on the Business Impact of a No-Code Application Implementation

Aim
To study how the implementation of a no-code application affects the working of a small business, in terms of time, cost, accuracy and customer satisfaction.

Objectives
- To understand the problems faced by a business that depends on manual work.
- To study how a no-code application can solve these problems.
- To compare the business before and after implementation.
- To list the benefits and limitations of the no-code approach.

Selected Business
A small stationery and office-supplies distributor with 12 employees was selected as a sample business. It supplies items to schools and small offices in the nearby area. Orders were received by phone and WhatsApp, written in a notebook, and later entered into Excel sheets by the office staff. The figures used in this case study are sample values taken to explain the idea and are not data of any real company.

Problems in the Existing System
- Orders were noted by hand, so mistakes in item name and quantity were common.
- Stock details were updated only once a day, so items were sometimes promised even when they were out of stock.
- Owner approval for discounts was taken over phone calls and was not recorded.
- Preparing the weekly sales report took almost half a day.
- Customers had no way of knowing the status of their orders.

No-Code Solution Implemented
A business application was built on a no-code platform (Zoho Creator) without writing a separate program. It was built by one office staff member in about two weeks with the help of ready-made templates.

Module	Purpose
Customer Order Form	Staff enter customer name, items and quantity directly into one form
Inventory Report	Shows the current stock and updates after every order
Discount Approval	Requests above a fixed limit are sent to the owner for approval
Sales Dashboard	Shows daily and monthly sales using charts

Module	Purpose
Email Notification	Sends order confirmation and delivery status to customers

Business Impact

Comparison before and after implementation (sample values)

Parameter	Before	After
Time to record one order	8 minutes	2 minutes
Order entry errors per month	About 25	About 4
Time to prepare weekly report	4 hours	Few seconds (automatic)
Discount approval time	Up to 1 day	About 30 minutes
Stock updating	Once a day	Instantly
Customer complaints per month	About 15	About 5
Development cost	Not applicable	Low - monthly subscription only

Steps Followed for Implementation

1. The owner and staff listed the problems of the manual system and the details needed in an order.
2. The order form, inventory form and customer details form were created using drag and drop.
3. Old stock and customer data from the Excel sheets were imported into the application.
4. Rules were added for discount approval and for email notification.
5. Staff were trained for two days and the new system was run along with the old notebook for one week.
6. After the trial week the manual notebook was stopped and only the application was used.

Cost Details (sample values)

Item	Traditional Software Development	No-Code Application
Development time	3 to 4 months	2 weeks
People needed	Developer, tester, project manager	One trained staff member
Initial cost	High	Very low

Item	Traditional Software Development	No-Code Application
Changes after release	Needs developer; takes days	Done by staff in minutes
Running cost	Server and maintenance charges	Monthly subscription

Benefits Observed

- Faster order processing and fewer mistakes.
- Real-time view of stock and sales for the owner.
- All approvals and orders are stored and can be checked later.
- The application was built without hiring a programmer, so the development cost and time were low.
- Changes such as adding a new field could be made by the staff themselves.

Limitations Observed

- Monthly subscription cost increases as the number of users grows.
- The business depends on the platform provider for features and availability.
- Very special requirements may not be possible without some scripting.
- Staff needed a short training before using the system.

Result

The case study showed that, in the sample business, the no-code application reduced the order processing time, the number of errors and the effort for reports, and it also improved the speed of decisions.

Conclusion

No-code implementation is an effective way for small businesses to move from manual work to a digital system without a large investment. It gives quick results and can be managed by non-technical staff. However, the business should also consider long-term subscription cost and platform dependency before selecting this approach.